

WHAT IS AN APOSTLE?

A TECHNICAL ANALYSIS OF
THE GRAMMAR OF SCRIPTURE

TRADITION VS. SCRIPTURE



MATTHEW 15:12-13

Then came his disciples, and said unto him,
Knowest thou that the Pharisees were offended,
after they heard this saying?
But he answered and said,
Every plant, which my heavenly Father hath not
planted, shall be rooted up.

VOL. I

Introduction

For centuries, modern theological instruction has operated under a widely accepted framework regarding the nature and duration of spiritual offices. What began during the Reformation as a historical argument against specific ecclesiastical claims has, over time, hardened into rigid systematic dogmatism. Today, much of Protestant church tradition routinely maintains two core pillars regarding the question “What is an apostle?”:

- That the specific office of the apostle ceased permanently with the passing of the first-century church.
- That entry into the apostolic office required being a physical eyewitness of the risen Christ.

While early post-Reformation writers often left room for God to raise up extraordinary messengers during times of systemic decline or church restoration, subsequent generations progressively locked that door shut. Over the last four centuries, further solidified by post-Reformation scholasticism and 19th-century cessationist theology, the traditional view evolved from a flexible historical response into an absolute, universal law. Today, this tradition heavily influences how many believers read the Bible, shaping modern teachings on church authority, spiritual gifts, and the operational structure of the body of Christ.

Many churches today frequently treat these traditional parameters as self-evident Biblical facts. However, when systemic doctrines are accepted without examination, human traditions risk obscuring the plain, syntactical structure of the Bible itself.

The purpose of this treatise is to evaluate this foundational topic by stepping outside of centuries-old institutional assumptions and returning strictly to the text. Rather than relying on historical consensus or extra-Biblical definitions, this study examines the question primarily through the boundary lines of Biblical English grammar and internal scriptural mechanics. Historical observations are explored only to explain how certain interpretive traditions arose. By subjecting key passages to rigorous syntactic, semantic, and contextual analysis, this work tests whether traditional cessationism is actually demanded by the text.

Considering how deeply entrenched these traditional frameworks have become in modern Christian thought, prepare yourself to evaluate complex, highly challenging concepts that demand careful meditation on the Scriptures, disciplined critical thinking, and prayer.

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Analysis Framework

This study analyzes the precise English grammar and syntax of the 1769 Holy Bible, commonly known as the Authorized King James Bible. It is recognized as the authoritative, inerrant word of God. Any alteration to the KJV, any underlying Hebrew, Aramaic, or Greek manuscript, any definition, or any modern translation that contradicts, alters, or violates the grammar and syntax of the 1769 Holy Bible is recognized as corrupt and rejected.

This study does not claim that grammar alone answers every theological question. Rather, grammar establishes the permissible structural readings upon which theology must build. Therefore, any theological objection must first demonstrate that the grammatical analysis is incorrect before proposing an alternative doctrinal conclusion.

To evaluate Biblical texts with technical precision, we must distinguish between the three distinct layers of language analysis: syntax, semantics, and pragmatics.

1. **Syntax** (structural constraint)

- **Definition:** The grammatical rules, sentence arrangements, determiners, pronouns, and structural relationships between words.
- **Function in analysis:** Syntax establishes the **structural boundaries** of a sentence. It does not dictate every nuanced meaning, but it strictly governs what relationships the text permits or forbids (eg. whether two nouns are bound into a single subject or isolated as distinct categories).

2. **Semantics** (lexical range)

- **Definition:** The dictionary definitions, word roots, and semantic ranges of individual terms (eg. *apostolos* meaning "one sent").
- **Function in analysis:** Semantics defines **what a word can mean** in isolation.

3. **Pragmatics & Theology** (interpretive discourse)

- **Definition:** The broader contextual, historical, and systematic conclusions drawn from reading texts in context.
- **Function in analysis:** Theology is built within the pragmatic realm. However, valid theology **must remain constrained** by syntax and semantics.

The objective method of this study

A common breakdown in theological debate occurs when readers jump directly to **pragmatics/theology** (forcing a passage to fit a pre-existing system or thought) while violating basic **syntax** and **semantics**. This study intentionally **begins with formal syntax** for a crucial reason:

Syntax places non-negotiable boundaries on interpretation. Before a theological system can claim what a verse means, the syntax of the sentence must first allow that structural relationship to exist.

By prioritizing syntactic boundaries first:

1. We prevent systematic theology from forcing sentences into structures the text does not contain.
2. We evaluate the KJB text as a consistent, structurally unified linguistic witness.
3. We isolate objective structural rules (such as the *single-determiner rule* or *anaphoric pronoun resolution*) **before** drawing conclusions.

Dictionary definitions

Noah Webster's 1828

Apostle

APOS'TLE, n. [L. *apostalus*; Gr. *to send away, to sent.*]

A person deputed to execute some important business; but appropriately, a disciple of Christ commissioned to preach the gospel. Twelve persons were selected by Christ for this purpose; and Judas, one of the number, proving an apostate, his place was supplied by Matthias. [Acts 1](#).

The title of apostle is applied to Christ himself, [Heb 3:1](#). In the primitive ages of the church, other ministers were called apostles, [Rom 16](#); as were persons sent to carry alms from one church to another, [Phil 2:25](#). This title was also given to persons who first planted the Christian faith. Thus Dionysius of Corinth is called the apostle of France; and the Jesuit Missionaries are called apostles.

Among the Jews, the title was given to officers who were sent into distant provinces, as visitors or commissioners, to see the laws observed.

Apostle, in the Greek liturgy, is a book containing the epistles of St. Paul, printed in the order in which they are to be read in churches, through the year.

Strong's concordance

G652 ἀπόστολος (*apóstolos* | ap-os'-tol-os)

Derivation: from **G649**

Strong's: a delegate; specially, an ambassador of the Gospel; officially a commissioner of Christ ("apostle") (with miraculous powers)

KJV: apostle ([Mat 10:2](#)), messenger ([2Cor 8:23](#)), he that is sent ([Joh 13:16](#)).

See: G649

Cognate Group: G651 (apostleship), G649 (put in), G5570 (false teacher), G1821 (send), G652 (apostle), G3992 (send) Variants: ἀπόστολος

Hebrew Equivalents: H7971 מֵלֶכֶת

The word apostle itself simply means “messenger” ([2Cor 8:23](#)) or “he that is sent” ([John 13:16](#)). Throughout Scripture G652 carries the basic idea of someone that is sent of God. Thus, a strict Biblical definition of apostle could be “one that is sent of God”.

Historicity of the tradition

1. The Protestant Reformation (16th Century)

A major catalyst for defining the apostolic office as temporary and strictly limited was **John Calvin** and his contemporaries.

- **The Catholic Polemic:** The Roman Catholic Church argued for its supreme authority based on *apostolic succession*, the claim that the Pope and bishops directly inherited the office, authority, and continuous mantle of the original apostles.
- **The Reformers' Counter-Argument:** To undermine Rome's claim to ongoing apostolic authority, Calvin argued in his *Institutes of the Christian Religion* that God established both **temporary (extraordinary)** and **permanent (ordinary)** offices. Apostles, prophets, and evangelists were categorized as extraordinary offices meant only for the initiation of the Gospel age.
- To prove that the office had ceased, Reformed theologians **isolated** specific narrative parameters in Scripture, such as Peter's localized criteria for replacing Judas in [Acts 1:21–22](#) and Paul's rhetorical defense in [1 Corinthians 9:1](#), and elevated them into universal, rigid systemic laws for the definition of the office itself.

2. Countering the "Enthusiasts"

During the same era, the mainstream Reformers were fighting a two-front theological war. Beyond defending against Rome, they were also countering radical Reformation groups (often called "Enthusiasts" or radical Anabaptists) who claimed to receive fresh, direct, infallible revelations from God through contemporary apostolic or prophetic promptings.

By dogmatically declaring that an apostle *must* be a physical eyewitness to the resurrection, the Reformers built a theological firewall: if there are no living eyewitnesses to the resurrection, then there are no contemporary apostles, and consequently, no new authoritative text or revelation can be given outside the written canon.

3. Post-Reformation Scholasticism and Princeton Theology (19th–20th Century)

The tradition reached its modern, ultra-rigid formulation through Post-Reformation dogmatics and, most notably, the Princetonean theologians like **B.B. Warfield** (particularly in his 1918 work, *Counterfeit Miracles*).

- **The Mechanistic Closure:** Warfield and his contemporaries sought a logical, airtight argument against both Roman Catholic miracle claims and the early emergence of modern pentecostal/charismatic movements.
- **The "Apostles Only" Conundrum:** They formulated the argument that miraculous "sign gifts" were uniquely tied to the corporate office of the Apostle to authenticate the initial delivery of the New Covenant. They argued that only the original apostles had the power to transmit these capabilities to others. Therefore, once the last person who had personally seen the risen Christ died, the office ended, the supernatural authentication ceased, and the canon was complete.

Summary of Origin:

Much of this tradition was forged as a **theological defense mechanism**. It was built by 16th-century Reformers to strip the Papacy of its "apostolic" claims and to silence radical groups claiming new revelation. It was later solidified into a definitive, systematic rule by 19th-century cessationist theologians looking to establish a clean, historical boundary line at the end of the first century.

Quotes

from John Calvin's *The Institutes of the Christian Religion*
translated by Henry Beveridge. Published 1845. Book 4, Chapter 3, Section 4.
Statements relevant to this study have been highlighted.

The book can be obtained online at the following URLs:

<https://www.ccel.org/ccel/c/calvin/institutes/cache/institutes.pdf>

<https://cheerful-wmcdannell.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/john-calvin-institutes-of-the-christian-religion.pdf>

Book 4, Chapter 3, Section 4 Summary:

4. Second part of the chapter, treating of Ecclesiastical office-bearers in particular. Some of them, as **Apostles, Prophets, and Evangelists, temporary**. Others*, as Pastors and Teachers, perpetual and indispensable.

Book 4, Chapter 3, Section 4:

4. Those who preside over the government of the Church, according to the institution of Christ, are named by Paul, first, Apostles; secondly, Prophets; thirdly, Evangelists; fourthly, Pastors; and, lastly, Teachers (**Eph. 4:11****). Of these, only the two last have an ordinary office in the Church. The Lord raised up the other three at the beginning of his kingdom, and still occasionally raises them up when the necessity of the times requires. The nature of the apostolic function is clear from the command, "**Go ye into all the world, and preach the Gospel to every creature**" (**Mark 16:15**). No fixed limits are given them, but the whole world is assigned to be reduced under the obedience of Christ, that by spreading the Gospel as widely as they could, they might everywhere erect his kingdom. Accordingly, Paul, when he would approve his apostleship, does not say that he had acquired some one city for Christ, but had propagated the Gospel far and wide, had not built on another man's foundation, but planted churches where the name of his Lord was unheard. The apostles, therefore, were sent forth to bring back the world from its revolt to the true obedience of God, and everywhere establish his kingdom by the preaching of the Gospel; or, if you choose, they were like the first architects of the Church, to lay its foundations throughout the world. By **Prophets**, he means not all interpreters of the divine will, but those who excelled by special revelation; **none such now exist, or they are less manifest**. By Evangelists, I mean those who, while inferior in rank to the apostles, were next them in office, and even acted as their substitutes. Such were Luke, Timothy, Titus, and the like; perhaps, also, the seventy disciples whom our Saviour appointed in the second place to the apostles (**Luke 10:1**). According to this interpretation, which appears to me consonant both to the words and the meaning of Paul, **those three functions were not instituted in the Church to be perpetual**, but only to endure so long as churches were to be formed where none previously existed, or at least where churches were to be transferred from Moses to Christ; **although I deny not, that afterward God occasionally raised up Apostles, or at least Evangelists, in their stead, as has been done in our time**. For such were needed to bring back the Church from the revolt of Antichrist. **The office I nevertheless call extraordinary, because it has no place in churches duly constituted**. Next come Pastors and Teachers, with whom the Church never can dispense, and between whom, **I think, there is this difference, that teachers preside not over discipline, or the administration of the sacraments, or admonitions, or exhortations, but the interpretation of Scripture only**, in order that pure and sound doctrine may be maintained among believers. But all these are embraced in the pastoral office.

* = Use of the plural "Others" when **Eph 4:11** "pastors and teachers" is a compound phrase (one office).

** = The text quoted is from **1Co 12:28** but the reference given is **Eph 4:11**.

Grammar matters

Mark 1:16-17

¹⁶ Now as he walked by the sea of Galilee, he saw **Simon and Andrew** his brother casting a net into the sea: for **they** were fishers.

¹⁷ And **Jesus** said unto **them**, **Come ye after me, and I will make you to become fishers of men.**

Core word types

- **Noun:** a naming word. It identifies a specific person, place, thing, or idea.

Examples: Simon, Andrew, sea, net

- **Pronoun:** a replacement word. It is a shortcut word used to stand in for a noun so you don't have to keep repeating the same name.

Examples: he, his, they, them, ye, I, you

- **Antecedent:** The “anchor” word. It is the original noun, noun phrase, or pronoun that a pronoun refers back to.

Examples: Simon and Andrew ← they ← them ← ye ← you
Jesus ← me ← I

Now you might wonder, why is the antecedent for the pronoun “them” the pronoun “they” instead of the original nouns “Simon and Andrew”? That's because if multiple pronouns are used, each pronoun resolves *backwards* to the most accessible antecedent. In these examples, the pronoun resolution chains each form what is called a “co-reference chain” (or anaphoric chain).

In English grammar, a pronoun **must** agree with its antecedent in both **number** (singular or plural) and **gender** (masculine, feminine, or neuter). Understanding how *pronouns* resolve to their *antecedents* clarifies passages where multiple *nouns* function as a *single semantic unit*, like in the following example.

Daniel 4:13-14

¹³ I saw in the visions of my head upon my bed, and, behold, **a watcher and an holy one** came down from heaven;

¹⁴ **He** cried aloud, and said thus, Hew down the tree, and cut off his branches, shake off his leaves, and scatter his fruit: let the beasts get away from under it, and the fowls from his branches:

The word “*He*” in verse 14 is a **singular** pronoun. While the nearest preceding noun phrase is “*an holy one*”, it is joined to “*a watcher*” by the conjunction “*and*”.

Normally, two nouns joined by “and” create a **plural** subject (which would require the pronoun “They”). However, because the text uses the **singular** pronoun “*He*”, the **compound** phrase “*a watcher and an holy one*” functions as a **single semantic unit**. This common linguistic concept – known as **semantically singular coordination** (or a *singular coordinate subject*) occurs routinely in English when two linked terms refer to a single entity or unified idea. Here, it plainly indicates that “*a watcher*” and “*an holy one*” are not two separate entities, but rather two coordinated titles referring to one referent (entity).

Determiners in Scripture

A **determiner** is a word placed before a noun to clarify what the noun refers to. In Biblical English, the most common determiners you will encounter are:

- **Articles:** *the, a, an*
- **Possessive Pronouns:** *his, my, thy, their, your*
- **Demonstratives:** *these, those, this*

Rule 1: The Single-Determiner Rule (syntactic unity)

When two or more nouns are joined by a conjunction, but are preceded by only **one single determiner** at the beginning of the phrase, that determiner **distributes across all the nouns**. Shared determiners create a presumption of close syntactic unity or shared temporal framework within the clause; but, keep in mind it is not an absolute semantic merge in every context (eg. "the dogs and cats").

Example: [Ephesians 2:20](#)

*"...built upon the foundation of **the** apostles and prophets..."*

- **The syntax:** A single genitive preposition ("of") and a single definite article ("*the*") govern both coordinated nouns. The article is not repeated before "*prophets*" ("**of the** apostles and **of the** prophets" or "**the** apostles and **the** prophets").
- **The meaning:** Because there is only one determiner, "*apostles and prophets*" belong to one coordinated constituent. Shared determiners create a presumption of close syntactic unity unless the surrounding discourse (the context) distinguishes the coordinated nouns.

Example: [Acts 1:25](#)

*"That he may take part of **this** ministry and apostleship..."*

- **The syntax:** a single determiner modifies two coordinated nouns.
- **The meaning:** Judas did not abandon two different assignments. He fell from one single charge: the ministry that is defined by the apostolic office.

Rule 2: Repeated Determiners (grammatical separation)

When each noun in a list is preceded by its own **individual** determiner, the syntax explicitly separates the coordinated nouns by removing their shared modification. It **tends to establish** (but not always) that the items are **distinct, independent groups** that do not share the same boundaries, classification, temporal framework, etc.

Example: [Joel 2:25](#)

*"...**the** locust hath eaten, **the** cankerworm, and **the** caterpillar, and **the** palmerworm..."*

- **The syntax:** The definite article "*the*" is repeated before every single noun.
- **The meaning:** By repeating the determiner, the text grammatically presents these creatures as four separately modified entities.

Example: 1 Chronicles 22:19

*"...**your** heart and **your** soul..."*

- **The syntax:** The possessive pronoun "your" is explicitly **repeated** before each noun.
- **The meaning:** The repeated pronoun creates a grammatical boundary that treats the heart and the soul as two **distinct**, individual components rather than a single merged concept.

Rule 3: Methods of Syntactic isolation (grammatical separation)

When words are joined by a conjunction like "and," specific structural elements can isolate them into distinct, independent categories rather than a single compound unit.

A. Prepositional isolation (repeated prepositions)

A preposition (of, in, by, to) defines the relationship between a noun and the rest of the sentence. When a single preposition governs a list of nouns, it binds them into a single continuous thought. When the preposition is repeated before each noun, the syntax explicitly resets the relationship, treating each item as an independent, isolated entity.

Example: Ephesians 2:20

*"... built upon the foundation **of** the apostles and prophets..."*

- One preposition "of" governs both; they share one foundation.

Example: 1 Thessalonians 1:5

*"...came not unto you **in** word only, but also **in** power, and **in** the Holy Ghost, and **in** much assurance..."*

- The preposition "in" repeats before every item, grammatically separating them into distinct, individual characteristics.

B. Symmetrical possessive isolation (repeated possessives)

Similarly to determiners (Rule 2), repeating a possessive pronoun before each coordinated noun creates an explicit boundary around each item.

Example: Luke 24:39

*"...behold **my** hands and **my** feet, that it is I myself..."*

- Repeating "my" before feet prevents "hands and feet" from merging into a single generalized body unit, calling attention to each distinct part.

Parallelisms in the Bible

Type	Examples
Direct equivalence / direct structural	Gen 4:23 (synonymous parallelism; Hebrew poetry) Jdg 18:17-18 ("graven image" & "carved image") Deu 32:2 (symmetrical structural equivalence)
Conceptual substitution (one idea is substituted for another)	Gen 1:8 (firmament & heaven), Gen 1:10, Psa 119:105
Synonymous (two different phrases that convey the same idea)	Job 3:11, Psa 120:2, Psa 19:1, Pro 16:18, Isa 55:6
Antithetic (contrasting opposites)	Pro 10:1, Psa 1:6, Pro 15:1, Pro 14:34, Isa 54:7
Synthetic / Constructive (one phrase builds upon another)	Psa 23:1, Pro 4:23, Eph 2:21-22
Hendiadys (two nouns connected with "and" function as a noun + adjective/modifier)	Gen 19:24 ("brimstone and fire") 1Sa 28:3 ("in Ramah, and in his own city") 2Sa 20:19 ("a city and a mother") Mat 4:16 ("region and shadow of death") Luk 21:15 ("mouth and wisdom") Acts 14:13 ("oxen and garlands") 2Ti 1:10 ("life and immortality")
Emblematic (an emblem, figure, simile or analogy is used to illustrate a spiritual, moral, or literal reality)	Psa 42:1, Pro 11:22, Psa 103:13, Pro 25:25, Pro 26:1
Climactic / Staircase (the second phrase repeats a phrase or clause and adds to it)	Psa 29:1-2, Psa 93:3, Psa 121:1-2
Chiastic / Inverted (a phrase is ideologically repeated in reverse order)	Gen 9:6, Mat 19:30, Mat 23:12, Isa 55:8

Hendiadys (plural *Hendiadyoin*)

/hen'diədəs/

A hendiadys is a figure of speech where a single, complex idea is expressed by joining two words together with a conjunction (like "and") instead of using a modifier. Its name is derived from the Greek phrase *hen-dia-dyoin* ("one through two"), it gives a thought more emphasis or poetic force.

Common Examples:

- "Nice and warm" instead of "pleasantly warm"
- "Good and ready" instead of "completely ready"
- "Sick and Tired" instead of "exceedingly tired" or "deeply frustrated"
- "Try and do it" instead of "try to do it"
- "The birds and the bees" instead of "the reproductive facts of a single species"

Hendiadyoin can most easily be recognized when two words are joined by "and" where one word modifies the other. For example, in Gen 3:16 "*thy sorrow and thy conception*". God did not multiply two separate things. Instead, it could be understood as "thy conception-sorrow".

The twelve apostles

(“the twelve” & “the twelve apostles of the Lamb”)

Matthew 10:2

Now the names of **the twelve apostles**^{G652} are these; The first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother;

Mark 6:30

And **the apostles**^{G652} gathered themselves together unto Jesus, and told him all things, both what they had done, and what they had taught.

Luke 6:13

And when it was day, he called unto him **his disciples**: and of them he chose twelve, whom **also he named apostles**^{G652};

- “The twelve” disciples are also called apostles **during** Christ’s ministry.
- Six times (potentially seven) “the twelve” are called apostles **before** Christ resurrected.
- These also appear to be well before they were *sent* to do anything for God.

If “seeing the risen Christ” were a requirement for being called an apostle we’re left with two options:

1. God used the wrong word to describe the twelve in at least six places.
2. God used a prolepsis (referring to a thing by its future-name).

Since point one isn’t possible, we’re left with one option and it is a good one. Prolepses are fairly common in Scripture. Here are a few examples in addition to the verses above:

- **Jerusalem**
 - God calls Jebus Jerusalem long before it was conquered by king David.
 - **Jos 10:1,3,5,23, 15:8**, etc.
- **Bethel**
 - Jacob names a place Bethel in **Gen 28:19**.
 - His grandfather Abraham visited the same place in **Gen 12:8, 13:3** and God calls it by its future-name Bethel.
- The city of **Dan** / northern allotment of Dan
 - In **Genesis 14:14-15**, Abraham pursued the captors of his nephew Lot “unto Dan”.
 - Not only did the tribe of Dan not exist yet but neither did the man that the tribe and the city would be named after (**Jdg 18:29**).
- The **Amalekites** (**Gen 14:7**)
 - Amalek the grandson of Esau (**Gen 36:12**) wasn’t born yet.
- Ur of the **Chaldees** (**Gen 11:28,31**)
 - The Chaldeans had not yet risen to prominence or established dominion of that region yet.

Other apostles

Acts 14:14

Which when **the apostles**^{G652}, Barnabas and Paul, heard of, they rent their clothes, and ran in among the people, crying out,

Romans 16:7

Salute Andronicus and Junia, my kinsmen, and my fellowprisoners, **who are of note among the apostles**^{G652}, who also were in Christ before me.

Galatians 1:19

But other of **the apostles**^{G652} saw I none, **save James** the Lord's brother.

1 Thessalonians 2:6 (Silas/Silvanus & Timothy; 1Th 1:1)

Nor of men sought we glory, neither of you, nor yet of others, when **we** might have been burdensome, as **the apostles**^{G652} **of Christ**.

- All of the other apostles are recorded as having seen the risen Christ (1Co 15:5-7).
- Andronicus, Junia, James, and Timothy/Timotheus are **never** recorded as having any miraculous powers.
- Barnabas (Joses Acts 4:36) is recorded as “having miraculous powers” (Acts 15:12).
- Silas/Silvanus is recorded as praying with Paul before the earthquake happened (which may or may not imply “miraculous powers”) (Acts 16:25,26).

The **lack** of evidence that is required to **prove** that an apostle had to have miraculous powers is sufficient to drop any notion of that requirement (1Th 5:21). And since people other than “the twelve” are called apostles, the phrase “the apostles” **is not** uniquely applied to “the twelve”. Which way the phrase is being used can be discerned from the context. For example:

Galatians 1:18-19 ¹⁸ Then after three years I [Paul] went up to Jerusalem to see Peter, and abode with him fifteen days. ¹⁹ But other of the apostles saw I none, save James the Lord's brother.	Since James the Lord's brother is not one of “the twelve” (Mat 10:2-4), here Paul is referring to “any of the apostles”.
Mark 6:7,30 ⁷ And he called unto him the twelve, and began to send them forth by two and two; and gave them power over unclean spirits; ... ³⁰ And the apostles gathered themselves together unto Jesus, and told him all things, both what they had done, and what they had taught.	“the twelve” which had been sent, when they returned, are called “the apostles”.

1. The office of apostle is not exclusive to the twelve.
2. Miraculous powers are not an exclusive sign of an apostle due to 1) lack of proof that every named apostle had them and 2) the existence of those that are not named apostles that did have them (Mar 9:38/Luk 9:49, Acts 6:8, 8:6, 9:17; cf. 1Co 12:29,30, 2Cor 12:11-12).
3. Miracles and wonders are not an exclusive gift given to the apostles or the twelve nor were they solely for the Jews (Acts 13:6-12, 14:8-18, 15:12, 19:11-12,19, 28:1-6, Rom 15:18-19) or solely for the New Testament “age” (Exo 14:21, 1Ki 17:21-22, 2Ki 4:6, et. al.).

Pre-Messianic apostles

Luke 11:49-51 (past tense)

⁴⁹ Therefore also said the wisdom of God, I will send^{G649} them **prophets and apostles**^{G652}, and some of them they shall slay and persecute:

⁵⁰ That the blood of **all the prophets**, which was shed from the foundation of the world, may be required of this generation;

⁵¹ From the blood of Abel unto the blood of Zacharias, which perished between the altar and the temple: verily I say unto you, It shall be required of this generation.

In verse 49, Christ introduces "*prophets and apostles*" as the compound subject, but in verse 50 He immediately collapses them into the singular group noun "*the prophets*". Verse 51 strictly constrains the temporal framework of those spoken of (from Abel to Zacharias). Because "*apostles*" does not grammatically modify "*prophets*," this is not a hendiadys. Instead, this sentence uses *direct structural parallelism*. This grammatical shift provides a clear textual basis demonstrating that "*apostles*" in this context is not a uniquely novel New Testament class, but rather a functional description ("sent ones") of those same Old Testament messengers.

Matthew 23:34-35 (present/future tense)

³⁴ Wherefore, behold, I send^{G649} unto you **prophets, and wise men, and scribes**: and some of them ye shall kill and crucify; and some of them shall ye scourge in your synagogues, and persecute them from city to city:

³⁵ That upon you may come all **the righteous** blood shed upon the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel unto the blood of Zacharias son of Barachias, whom ye slew between the temple and the altar.

The parallel account in **Matthew** provides more textual proof of this functional definition. While **Luke** lists two groups ("*prophets and apostles*") and **Matthew** lists three ("*prophets, and wise men, and scribes*"), they are **structurally identical** in how they map to each other. By doing so, Christ declares that He is the one who *sent* in the Old Testament, and He is the one who *sends* them now and for ever.

Passage	Active Verb	Listed Groups	Summary Group
Luk 11:49-50	"I will send" (G649 - <i>apostellō</i>)	prophets and apostles	"the prophets"
Mat 23:34-35	"I send" (G649 - <i>apostellō</i>)	prophets, wise men, and scribes	"the righteous"

Both lists are governed by the active verb "*send*". Because "*prophets*" is common to both lists, the term "*apostles*" in **Luke** occupies the exact same **structural position** as "*wise men, and scribes*" in **Matthew**.

To find the "*apostles*" of Luke 11 occupying the exact structural position of Matthew's "*wise men, and scribes*" demonstrates a clear functional equivalence between the terms. In his *Commentary on a Harmony of the Evangelists* (Vol. 3, Page 101), John Calvin recognizes this exact textual correspondence and in doing so concedes that "*apostle*" functions as a general category for God's sent messengers throughout Scripture:

"Instead of wise men and scribes, Luke mentions apostles, but the meaning is the same."

Calvin's *Commentary on a harmony of the Evangelists* can be obtained at the following URLs:

- <https://calvin.edu/sites/default/files/migrated/centers-institutes-meeter-center-files-john-calvins-works-in-english-Commentary-20033---Harmony-of-the-Evangelists-Matthew-Mark-Luke-Vol.-3.pdf>
- <https://cheerful-wmcdannell.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/john-calvin-harmony-of-the-evangelists-matthew-mark-luke-volume-3.pdf>

The Gift that keeps on giving

Ephesians 4:8-13

⁸ Wherefore he saith, **When he ascended up on high**, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men.
⁹ (Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth?
¹⁰ He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)
¹¹ And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers;
¹² **For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ:**
¹³ **Till** we all come in the unity of the faith, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ:

Syntactic boundary & temporal framework:

Ephesians 4:8–13 presents **all five gifts** within **one** uninterrupted temporal framework. God establishes a single, unbroken time frame beginning at Christ's ascension (v8) and ending when the entire body of Christ reaches "*the unity of the faith*" (v13).

Because all five gifts are grouped together within this same explicit boundary, claiming that we need pastors today but not apostles runs contrary to the most natural syntactic reading of the text. To assert that the office of the apostle has ended requires restricting the Biblical use of *apostolos* to a single, arbitrarily time-limited historical office.

If the "till" of verse 13 has not yet passed, then declaring the apostolic office ended demands the structurally inconsistent conclusion that evangelists, prophets, and pastors have ended as well.

Furthermore, extracting any of these gifts out of their contextual temporal framework and then segregating them constitutes an inconsistent interpretation of the grammatical structure.

Note on Ephesians 2:20:

Cessationists often claim the "foundation" was laid and finished in the first century. When confronted with **1Co 3:11**, they typically assert that while Christ is the primary foundation, the apostles served as a unique, historical "instrumental foundation" whose function ended once the initial groundwork was laid. Does Scripture support this distinction? Notice how the Bible defines the act of laying the foundation:

1 Corinthians 3:9-11

⁹ For we are labourers together with God: ye are God's husbandry, ye are God's building.
¹⁰ According to the grace of God which is given unto me, as a wise masterbuilder, **I have laid the foundation**, and another buildeth thereon. But let every man take heed how he buildeth thereupon.
¹¹ For other foundation can no man lay than that is laid, **which is Jesus Christ**.

Scripture explicitly distinguishes between the foundation itself and the instruments who lay it. The foundation is Jesus Christ. It is not made up of men – it is laid by men – as exemplified by Paul himself in v10. How Paul (and anyone else) lays that foundation is explicitly laid out in **1Co 15:3-4** (notice also "...*that which I also received...*").

To claim that the men themselves constitute a secondary, temporary foundation confuses the builder with the foundation being laid. Everyone that preaches Jesus is laying that same foundation upon which every one who receives Him is then built upon (**Isa 28:16**, **Eph 2:20**).

Paul as the last apostle

Somehow people use the following verses to “prove” that Paul was the last apostle (ever). We’ve already demonstrated the structural flaw in that possibility so we’ll just look at what is there and break it down.

1 Corinthians 15:5-8

⁵ And that he was seen of Cephas, then of the twelve:

⁶ After that, he was seen of above five hundred brethren at once; of whom the greater part remain unto this present, but some are fallen asleep.

⁷ After that, he was seen of James; then of all the apostles.

⁸ And last of all he was seen of me also, as of one born out of due time.

- Paul does not call himself an apostle nor does he count himself among them (v5,7) **in this context**.
- The list of people **are not all apostles**.
 - In order to even be considered for a standard for all apostles, without committing the fallacy known as *affirming the consequent*, **everyone** on this list would need to be an apostle **and** it would also need to include **all** apostles in the entire Bible.
- The only thing Paul is the “*last of*” here is this list of people in this order:
 1. Cephas (Simon Peter; one of the twelve)
 2. The twelve (called apostles elsewhere: [Mat 10:2,3](#))
 3. Above 500 brethren at once (**not called apostles anywhere**)
 4. James (called an apostle elsewhere: [Gal 1:19](#))
 5. **all** the apostles
 6. last of all, Paul (called an apostle elsewhere: [Rom 1:1](#))
- Note: all means all. “The twelve” were already listed so “all the apostles” is not a phrase that means “the twelve” here.

These verses do prove that all of the named and unnamed apostles in the New Testament saw the risen Christ. But, what about the apostles in the Old Testament? And what about the apostles that have been and will continue to be sent long after the first century church?

In order to even consider that “seeing the risen Christ” was a requirement to be called an apostle, we would first need evidence of **every** apostle in the **entire** Bible having done so. That evidence does not exist so we can’t prove it and thus we should not hold fast to it.

We can only apply this requirement on an apostle if we **arbitrarily** limit the office of apostle to the New Testament like John Calvin does in *Institutes for the Christian Religion* (B4.C3.S4). I cannot explain to you how or why he did it because **he did not provide any proof** nor does he address the glaring issues with basic grammar that we have already explored.

John Calvin, *Institutes for the Christian Religion* Book 4, Chapter 3, Section 4 summary:

“4. Second part of the chapter, treating of Ecclesiastical office-bearers in particular. Some of them, as Apostles, Prophets, and Evangelists, **temporary**. Others, as Pastors and Teachers, **perpetual** and indispensable.”

Qualifications for an apostle

To establish the tradition that an apostle must needs have seen the risen Christ, these verses are used.

Acts 1:21-22

²¹ Wherefore of these men which have companied with us all the time that the Lord Jesus went in and out among us,

²² Beginning from the baptism of John, unto that same day that he was taken up from us, **must one be ordained to be a witness with us of his resurrection.**

We've already established with Scripture that being one of "the twelve" **is not** a requirement to be called an apostle. This context only covers the requirements for being one of "the twelve" which is a subset of all the named apostles in Scripture. Therefore, these verses have nothing to do with defining the requirements for an apostle.

1 Corinthians 9:1-2

¹ Am I not an apostle? am I not free? have I not seen Jesus Christ our Lord? are not ye my work in the Lord?

² If I be not an apostle unto others, yet doubtless I am to you: for **the seal of mine apostleship are ye** in the Lord.

Paul is defending his personal authority against critics in Corinth who were personally attacking **him**. He is listing **his** unique, top-tier credentials, not a bare-minimum entry requirement. The text doesn't even imply that these are requirements for **every** apostle. Taking Paul's "qualifications" and then transplanting them as requirements for every/any other apostle is a logical fallacy known as *affirming the consequent*.

The fallacy takes this structural form:

- If P, then Q. (eg. If it's raining, the sidewalk is wet.)
- Q is true. (eg. The sidewalk is wet.)
- Therefore, P is true. (eg. Therefore, it is raining.)

This argument is invalid because other factors could explain why the sidewalk is wet (eg. a sprinkler or a broken fire hydrant).

Likewise, just because Paul has these qualifications does not necessitate that every apostle needed to have these qualifications. This is most easily proven by the fact that "*are not ye my work in the Lord?*" **does not** apply to **all** apostles and "*am I not free?*" does not necessarily apply to **all** apostles. If we were to **imply/assume** that these qualifications are for every apostle, how then could we justify cherry-picking which of the listed qualifications apply and which don't?

Lastly, Paul states himself the seal/proof/stamp of his apostleship (that is to say, the proof of him being sent of God **is** the Corinthian believers themselves):

*"...for **the seal of mine apostleship are ye** in the Lord."*

Internal textual mechanics

1 Corinthians 13:8-12

⁸ Charity never faileth: but whether there be **prophecies**, they shall fail; whether there be **tongues**, they shall cease; whether there be **knowledge**, it shall vanish away.

⁹ For we know in part, and we prophesy in part.

¹⁰ But when that which is perfect is come, then that which is in part shall be done away.

¹¹ When I was a child, I spake as a child, I understood as a child, I thought as a child: but when I became a man, I put away childish things.

¹² For now we see through a glass, darkly; **but then face to face**: now I know in part; but then shall I know even as also I am known.

John Calvin, B.B. Warfield, and modern proponents like John MacArthur use **1Co 13:8-11** to define "*that which is perfect*" as the completed canon of Scripture. They assert that once the full New Testament was written, prophecies and tongues vanished because the "partial" revelation was no longer needed. However, their interpretation has one glaring omission.

Prophecies, tongues, **and knowledge** are all bound together within the exact same syntactic clause and governed by the same temporal framework. To claim that prophecies and tongues ceased in the first century creates a grammatical flaw: if those gifts vanished with the completion of the canon, then partial knowledge must have ended then as well, yet Scripture proves partial knowledge continues until we see Him face to face (v12).

- **Prophecy**: Preaching and declaring God's truth from partial understanding remains active throughout the present age.
- **Tongues**: Spoken languages (**Acts 2:6**) continue as God's means of communication across nations.
- **Knowledge**: Partial, growing knowledge, whether spiritual or general, continues to be given to believers (**Isa 28:9**, **Joh 16:13**).

To isolate one coordinated element while ignoring the shared governing verbs in the sequence is to make an unfounded claim about the text. Their interpretation completely distorts the passage while ignoring the beautiful, poetic parallelism of a maturing human (v11) paired with the literal reality (v12), both of which define verse 10.

The Holy Ghost constructs a seamless bridge between metaphorical illustration in verse 11 and literal reality in verse 12 to define "*that which is perfect*". In Biblical usage, "*perfect*" does not merely mean flawless moral purity, but rather full completion, total maturity, or reaching the intended end goal.

In verse 11, the childhood state, speaking, understanding, and thinking as a child, represents our current, incomplete earthly existence. The shift to adulthood signifies reaching full completion, which verse 12 explicitly defines as moving from dim, indirect reflection into complete, direct presence ("*face to face*").

By pairing the allegory of human growth with literal reality, Scripture defines the phrase "*when that which is perfect is come*" as the moment things reach their ultimate, full completion. This applies **both** individually and corporately: for the individual believer, it is the glorification experienced when standing face to face with the Lord; for the corporate body of Christ, it is the final, fully matured state realized at His return.

Lastly, the completion of the written canon in the first century did not bring individual believers or the Church as a whole into full face-to-face completion, nor did it grant full, exhaustive knowledge ("*even as also I am known*"). To force the text to mean the first-century canon requires borrowing logic from outside the sentence structure, disregarding the shared temporal frame. Verse 12 strongly indicates that "*that which is perfect*" is not an earthly book in a partial world, but the total completion of our redemption.

Conclusion

When the traditions of men are stripped away and the English text of the Authorized King James Bible is subjected to rigorous grammatical and contextual analysis, the historical premise of cessationism is severely undermined. By treating the Holy Bible not as a loose collection of concepts to be reinterpreted through human scholarship or foreign glosses, but instead as an exact, syntactically precise revelation that defines itself, a complete and harmonious picture of the apostolic office emerges. A systematic review of the textual evidence yields these definitive conclusions:

The Functional Identity of the Office:

Etymologically and scripturally, an apostle (*apostolos*) is simply "one sent of God" ([John 13:16](#), [2 Corinthians 8:23](#)). Scriptural usage proves that the title is neither restricted to "the twelve" nor bounded by the first-century church.

Old Testament Continuity:

Through the structural parallelisms of [Luke 11:49-50](#) and [Matthew 23:34-35](#), the structural correspondence identifies Old Testament prophets, wise men, and scribes as "*apostles*" (those sent). The sending of apostolic messengers is not a novel New Testament creation, but God's historical and continuous method of reaching mankind.

The Ascension Gifts Framework:

[Ephesians 4:8-13](#) establishes a single, unbroken temporal framework for all five gifts, whose intended purpose is explicitly defined in v12, beginning at Christ's ascension and extending "*till we all...*" To arbitrarily claim that pastors continue while apostles have ceased breaks the unified syntax of the sentence. Furthermore, [1 Corinthians 3:9-11](#) demonstrates that Jesus Christ alone is the singular foundation ([Ephesians 2:20](#)); ministers are simply laborers (v9) who lay that foundation whenever they preach Jesus Christ, proving the foundation is not made up of temporary men.

Disarming the "Eyewitness" Fallacy:

Textual analysis reveals that localized criteria, such as Peter's requirements for replacing Judas in [Acts 1:21-22](#) (which applies strictly to "the twelve") and Paul's defense of his personal credentials in [1 Corinthians 9:1](#), were never universal entry requirements for the office itself. Elevating Paul's unique experiences into mandatory laws for every apostle commits the logical fallacy known as *affirming the consequent*. Furthermore, [1 Corinthians 15:5-8](#) demonstrates that Paul was merely the last person on a specific historical list of resurrection witnesses.

Syntactic Solvent for Proof-Texts:

Passages traditionally used to argue for cessation can not withstand basic grammatical scrutiny. In [1 Corinthians 13:8-12](#), "prophecies," "tongues," and "knowledge" are bound within the same clause; to claim prophecy and tongues ended in the first century forces the absurd assertion that partial knowledge ended as well. "*That which is perfect*" (*full completion/maturity*) is explicitly defined by verse 12 as occurring at our redemption.

Taking a step back

When assembled into a unified whole, these textual indicators present a sturdy, cohesive framework: God has never revoked His historical method of sending commissioned messengers to build, edify, and perfect the body of Christ. This operational pattern was established from the beginning, reaffirmed at Christ's ascension, and will continue uninterrupted until the body of Christ reaches full maturity.

1. The Historical Root: defensive pragmatism vs. textual precision

Much of the traditional cessationist framework, forged during the Reformation under figures like John Calvin, was born out of an intense historical conflict. Its immediate purpose was to dismantle Roman Catholic claims of papal apostolic succession and counter radical enthusiast movements. However, rather than relying strictly on the self-defining syntax of Scripture, post-Reformation theologians adopted an extra-Biblical, historical defense. They attempted to solve a practical ecclesiastical problem by declaring the office itself extinct. Scripture repeatedly warns against replacing divine command with human pragmatism (eg. [Numbers 13-14](#)). Prioritizing historical counter-arguments over strict textual execution has historically produced ongoing theological division, strife, and debate rather than doctrinal clarity ([Matthew 7:20](#)).

2. Practical Application: testing vs. elimination

Restoring the Scriptural framework does not mean opening the door to lawlessness, self-appointed hierarchy, or un-vetted authority. On the contrary, Biblical syntax provides a much higher standard of accountability than traditional cessationism ever could.

- **Expectation of false workers:** Scripture explicitly warns that deceitful workers and false apostles will persist alongside genuine ministry throughout the "church age" ([2 Corinthians 11:13-15](#)).
- **The approval of testing:** God explicitly commends testing those that claim to be sent of God ([Revelation 2:2](#)).

A Biblical church does not protect itself by locking the door against God's gifts; it protects itself by applying the strict boundary lines of Scripture to test every worker's doctrine, fruit, and commission.

3. Realigning expectations

Practically applying these conclusions requires shifting the Church's operational paradigm from institutional tradition back to the commandments of God:

- **Rejecting human wisdom:** let the Bible set the boundaries for interpretation. Let the Bible define itself.
- **Rejecting extra-Biblical credentials:** stop requiring localized or non-universal experiences as blanket laws for divine commission.
- **Focusing on the build, not the person:** recognizing that Jesus Christ is the only foundation that will endure ([1 Corinthians 14:12](#)).
- **Pursuing the intended goal:** According to [Ephesians 4:12-13](#), the fivefold ministry gifts are actively given "*for the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ.*" To reject the ongoing operation of any of these gifts necessarily opposes the very mechanism God appointed to bring His Church into full maturity.

By stepping back from centuries of institutional dogmatism and standing strictly on the precision of Biblical English syntax, our perspective can then be restored to its God-ordained order: equipped by all the ascension gifts, protected by rigorous Scriptural testing, and grounded solely on the foundation of the Lord Jesus Christ, the Word of God.

Directors cut

The process of rigorous logical deduction remains incomplete unless we actively subject our conclusions to falsification. Proving a thesis demands more than assembling supporting evidence; it requires an intentional effort to test the hypothesis against potential counter-arguments and challenging texts. Only when conclusions withstand relentless internal testing should they be offered with confidence for objective evaluation and peer review. To that end, this study itself has been repeatedly subjected to criticism, from every imaginable angle using all of the tools at my disposal. The strongest of those potential weak points and their conclusions have been documented above; however, there remained quite a few tests for the conclusions that found no place in the final draft. Some of them are documented below.

1 Corinthians 4:6-14

⁶ And these things, brethren, I have in a figure transferred to myself and to Apollos for your sakes; **that ye might learn in us not to think of men above that which is written, that no one of you be puffed up for one against another.**

⁷ For who maketh thee to differ from another? and what hast thou that thou didst not receive? now if thou didst receive it, why dost thou glory, as if thou hadst not received it?

⁸ Now ye are full, now ye are rich, ye have reigned as kings without us: and I would to God ye did reign, that we also might reign with you.

⁹ **For I think that God hath set forth us the apostles last, as it were appointed to death:** for we are made a spectacle unto the world, and to angels, and to men.

¹⁰ We are fools for Christ's sake, but ye are wise in Christ; we are weak, but ye are strong; ye are honourable, but we are despised.

¹¹ Even unto this present hour we both hunger, and thirst, and are naked, and are buffeted, and have no certain dwellingplace;

¹² And labour, working with our own hands: being reviled, we bless; being persecuted, we suffer it:

¹³ Being defamed, we intreat: we are made as the filth of the world, and are the offscouring of all things unto this day.

¹⁴ I write not these things to shame you, but as my beloved sons **I warn you.**

Out of its context, v9 could be twisted to say something it does not. In its context, Paul uses the picture of a Roman *triumphus* (a victory parade) to contrast the heart-attitude of the Corinthians and the apostles. The underlying Greek uses the exact same every-day victory-parade terminology that would directly connect the Corinthian mind to something they were familiar with.

In the figure, the Corinthians are the “puffed up”, victorious generals and officers at the front of the parade. This represents their pride (self-exaltation) and their idolatry (esteeming some men higher than others)

The apostles are the the captured prisoners in the back of the parade (“*last*”), that were condemned to die in the amphitheater as a public spectacle (*theatron*). This represents their humility and submission to the will of God even in persecution and even unto death.

Paul states himself the entire purpose of the picture that follows in verse 6 (and v14):

1. Don't think of men higher than what is written. Consult the Scriptures for the truth about men.
2. Don't be puffed up *for one* against anyone else. (eg. don't think of one man being better than any other).

Thus, it is a warning against pride and idolatry ([Hab 2:4](#), [Rom 12:3](#), [Rom 12:16](#), [Gal 6:3](#), [Phil 2:3](#), [1Co 10:24](#)) and not a declaration of a limitation on spiritual gifts (which are nowhere mentioned in the context).

Revelation 21:14

And the wall of the city had twelve foundations, and in them the names of **the twelve apostles of the Lamb**.

As we have already seen, restricting the apostolic office to “the twelve” directly contradicts Scripture whereof many individuals aside from “the twelve” are called apostles (some explicit, some not). This is not even including the Old Testament apostles so named by Jesus Christ in [Luke 11:49-51](#), and the unnamed apostles that will be sent in the future. But, that’s not the interesting part. The interesting part is that the phrase “the twelve apostles” appears only three times in the entire Bible and this verse is the only instance where “the twelve” are singled out among all apostles and honored in a very specific way: each one of them is a specific foundation **of the wall** of holy Jerusalem which comes down from heaven. What does that mean? Good question :)

2 Corinthians 12:12

Truly **the signs of an apostle** were wrought among you in all patience, in signs, and wonders, and mighty deeds.

This passage is frequently cited to claim that performing physical miracles is an absolute, mandatory credential for anyone holding the apostolic office. Using this verse to establish a universal requirement requires committing the logical fallacy of *affirming the consequent*.

Syntactically, the verse asserts a historical fact regarding Paul’s **specific** (“*wrought among you*”) ministry only in Corinth. The text does not state, imply, or grammatically demand that every individual holding the office of an apostle must perform an identical set of signs, wonders, and mighty deeds.

Furthermore, elevating Paul’s localized defense into an absolute requirement for all apostles creates a direct contradiction within the text itself. Scripture explicitly identifies numerous individuals as apostles, such as Timothy and Silas ([1Th 1:1, 2:6](#)), Epaphroditus ([Phi 2:25](#)), and James the Lord’s brother ([Gal 1:19](#)), without recording a single miraculous sign worked by their hands. Conversely, non-explicit-apostles like Stephen and Philip worked “great wonders and miracles” ([Acts 6:8, 8:6](#)).

To demand that every apostle work miracles requires extrapolating Paul’s personal credentials into a universal law which is an **assumption** nowhere supported by Biblical syntax. When the text is allowed to define its own terms, “*the signs of an apostle*” refers to the evidence validating a **specific** messenger’s commission in a **specific** context, not a closed functional requirement for the office itself.

Jude 1:3 (cf. **Hebrews 1:1-2** & **Hebrews 2:3**)

Beloved, when I gave all diligence to write unto you of the common salvation, it was needful for me to write unto you, and exhort you that **ye should earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered** unto the saints.

A common cessationist proof-texting strategy uses **Jude 1:3** to argue that because "*the faith*" was "*once delivered*" (*once for all time*), the apostolic office must have ceased.

However, subjecting this argument to basic formal logic exposes a severe *non sequitur* (*it does not follow*):

1. **Premise A** (Biblical fact): The foundational body of doctrine ("*the faith*") was delivered once for all time to the saints.
2. **Premise B (unstated extra-Biblical assumption)**: Continuous spiritual offices can only exist if they are adding new scripture or new foundational doctrine to "*the faith*."
3. **Conclusion** (logical leap): Therefore, the offices of apostle and prophet have ceased.

The "Trojan Horse" Mechanics

Notice what is happening structurally: the argument leverages a truth that all Bible-believing Christians affirm, that the canon is closed and the core faith is complete, and then uses it as a "Trojan horse" to introduce Premise B, **a condition that appears nowhere in the text of **Jude** or anywhere else in Scripture.**

Jude 1:3 governs the **content** of the message ("*the faith*"), **not** the operational gifts of the messengers proclaiming it.

Delivering a complete set of laws or doctrines once for all time does not eliminate the ongoing need for ministers to proclaim them. On the contrary, Jude **explicitly commands** believers to "***earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered.***"

By equating the *delivery of the message* with the *termination of the messenger*, this cessationist argument requires an extra-Biblical leap that syntax simply does not support.

The typical cessationist assertion using **Hebrews 1:1-2** requires the exact same *non sequitur* flaw as **Jude 1:3** and likewise cannot stand against a basic formal logic test. **Hebrews 2:3** alone disproves any notion that direct revelation through human messengers was permanently replaced by the Son.

References	Cessationist assertion	Disproved by
2Co 12:11, 13:3	“Credentials of validation”. Assuming all apostles need to validate themselves the exact same way Paul did.	Logical fallacy, affirming the consequent.
Joh 14:26, 16:13	“All truth / canon closure” These promises were only and strictly for the original apostles in the upper room [to write the New Testament canon]	The Spirit of truth is the same as the Comforter which is the same as the Holy Ghost. If the revelation of truth was [arbitrarily] restricted to the New Testament canon then the giving of the Holy Ghost was also necessarily restricted (grammar requirement). Directly contradicts much of the book of Acts, John 3, and many others. Conflates the writing of New Testament Scripture with the revelation of truth by the Holy Ghost.

I haven't been able to find a single cessationist assertion that didn't require one or more of the following:

- A) Define Biblical words or phrases using man's wisdom instead of letting the Bible define itself.
- B) “Cherry-picking”
 - Defined as extracting a phrase, verse, sentence, or verses from its context and then interpreting it in isolation (often using A).
 - Doing this more often than not then requires C.
- C) Ignoring what the basic grammar of Scripture permits and forbids.
- D) The logical fallacy of *affirming the consequent* is very common. This is probably the least flagitious method of them all.
- E) “Trojan-horse” doctrine.
 - Defined as doctrine whose premise is truth, but included with it is an assertion that is not truth and/or cannot be proven with the Bible.

Matthew 15:14

Let them alone: they be blind leaders of the blind. And if the blind lead the blind, both shall fall into the ditch.